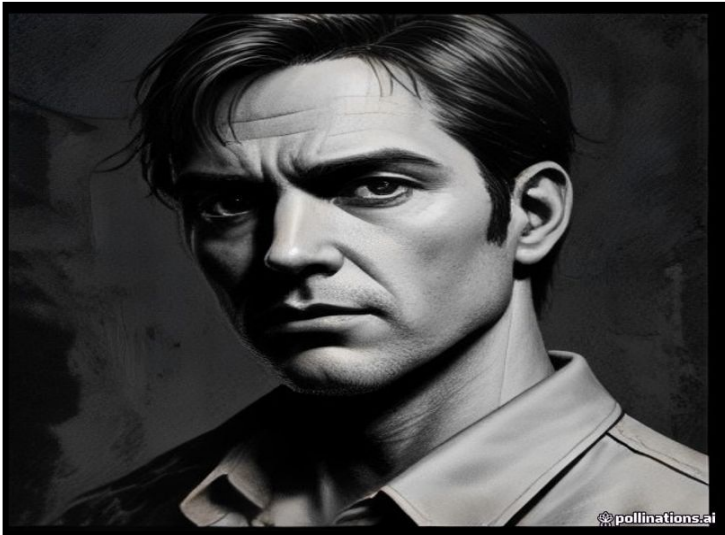


STYLE: DARK GRAPHIC NOVEL | GENRE: NEO-NOIR PSYCHOLOGICAL THRILLER

A weary detective pursuing an elusive phantom through the rain-drenched neon veins of the city confronts a terrifying reflection of his own guilt.

PANEL 1: THE GHOST IN THE PUDDLE [SPLASH...]



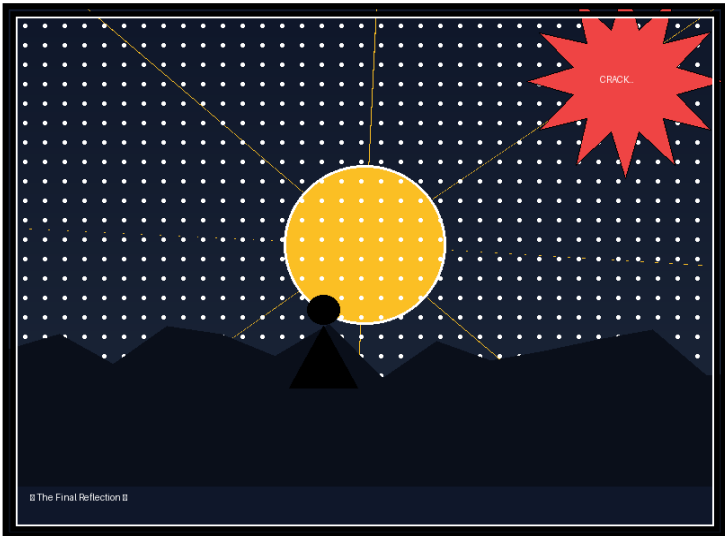
NARRATION:

*The rain didn't wash away the sins of the district; it just gave them a shiny coat of paint. Every puddle held a face I used to know.*

DETECTIVE VANCE:

"You're just a ghost made of bad whiskey and cheap regrets... so why the hell won't you stay dead?"

PANEL 2: THE FINAL REFLECTION [CRACK...]



NARRATION:

*The chase was never about the shadow running ahead. It was about the man who was too tired to stop running.*

DETECTIVE VANCE:

"...It was always you."